

Chapter 5: Green Skills—I

Detailed Answers

1 What are green skills? Why are they important for our future?

Answer:

Green skills are the knowledge, abilities, values, and attitudes that help people protect the environment and use natural resources responsibly. These skills help us understand environmental problems and find ways to reduce their harmful effects.

Green skills are important for our future because:

1. They help us **protect the environment** from pollution and damage.
2. They encourage the **responsible use of natural resources** such as water, forests, and energy.
3. They help reduce **waste and pollution**.
4. They support the development of **environment-friendly technologies and practices**.
5. They help create a **cleaner, healthier, and more sustainable future** for present and future generations.

For example, saving electricity, reducing plastic use, recycling waste, and using public transport are simple activities that reflect green skills.

2. What is sustainable development?

Answer:

Sustainable development means development that meets the needs of the present generation without reducing the ability of future generations to meet their own needs.

In simple words, it means using resources carefully so that we can improve our lives today while also protecting the environment and resources for the future.

Sustainable development focuses on maintaining a balance between **economic development, social well-being, and environmental protection**.

For example, using solar energy instead of depending completely on fossil fuels can provide energy while reducing environmental impact.

Some important ways to support sustainable development are:

1. **Saving water and electricity.**
2. **Using renewable sources of energy**, such as solar and wind energy.
3. **Reducing, reusing, and recycling waste.**
4. **Protecting forests and wildlife.**
5. **Using natural resources responsibly.**

Sustainable development is important because the resources of our planet are limited, and they need to be used responsibly.

3. Explain the 3Rs: Reduce, Reuse and Recycle with one example of each.

Answer:

The **3Rs—Reduce, Reuse, and Recycle**—are important practices for reducing waste and protecting the environment.

1. Reduce:

Reduce means using fewer resources and producing less waste. We should avoid unnecessary consumption.

Example: Carrying a reusable water bottle instead of buying disposable plastic bottles.

2. Reuse:

Reuse means using an item again instead of throwing it away after one use.

Example: Using one-sided printed paper for rough work or notes.

3. Recycle:

Recycle means processing waste materials so that they can be used to make new products.

Example: Collecting used paper and sending it to a recycling facility to produce recycled paper.

The 3Rs help us **reduce waste, conserve natural resources, save energy, and reduce pollution.**

4. What is meant by environmental conservation? Mention any three ways to conserve the environment.

Answer:

Environmental conservation means protecting and responsibly managing the environment and its natural resources. It includes protecting air, water, soil, forests, wildlife, and other natural resources from damage and unnecessary use.

Some ways to conserve the environment are:

1. **Save water:** Turn off taps when water is not needed and repair leaking taps.
2. **Save electricity:** Switch off lights, fans, and electronic devices when they are not being used.
3. **Plant and protect trees:** Trees help maintain ecological balance, provide habitats for animals, and improve air quality.
4. **Reduce plastic waste:** Avoid unnecessary single-use plastic items and use reusable alternatives.
5. **Manage waste properly:** Separate recyclable and non-recyclable waste and dispose of it responsibly.

Environmental conservation is important because a healthy environment is necessary for the well-being of humans, animals, and plants.

5. How can students help in reducing pollution in their school and neighbourhood?

Answer:

Students can play an important role in reducing pollution by developing environmentally responsible habits and encouraging others to do the same.

Students can help in the following ways:

1. **Avoid littering:** Put waste in the appropriate dustbins.
2. **Reduce plastic use:** Carry reusable water bottles, lunch boxes, and bags instead of using unnecessary single-use plastic.
3. **Save electricity:** Switch off lights, fans, computers, and other devices when they are not required.
4. **Use paper carefully:** Avoid wasting paper and use both sides whenever appropriate.
5. **Plant and care for trees:** Participate in tree-planting and school cleanliness activities.
6. **Use cleaner transportation:** Walk, cycle, or use shared/public transport when practical and safe.
7. **Spread awareness:** Encourage classmates, family members, and neighbours to follow environmentally friendly practices.

Small actions by many students can make a significant difference in keeping the school and neighbourhood cleaner.

6. A school produces a large amount of paper and plastic waste every day. Suggest five practical steps the school can take to manage this waste and protect the environment.**Answer:**

The school can introduce a proper waste-management system to reduce the amount of paper and plastic waste. Five practical steps are:

1. Separate waste:

Place separate bins for paper, plastic, food waste, and other types of waste. This makes it easier to manage and recycle materials.

2. Reduce paper usage:

Use digital notices and assignments where appropriate, avoid unnecessary printing, and use both sides of paper for rough work.

3. Encourage reusable items:

Students and staff can use reusable water bottles, lunch boxes, and other items instead of disposable plastic products.

4. Recycle waste:

Collect paper and suitable plastic separately and send them to authorised recycling facilities or waste-management services.

5. Create awareness:

The school can organise awareness campaigns, posters, activities, and classroom discussions to teach students about proper waste management and the 3Rs.

By following these steps, the school can **reduce waste, conserve resources, lower pollution, and develop environmentally responsible habits among students.**